

Lecture 05 (2026-07-05)

Quick Summary

The lecture covers the transition from "groups" to "teams," focusing on the benefits of team structures, the specific advantages they offer over individual or group work, and the defining characteristics that distinguish a "team" from a "work group" in an organizational context.

Key Definitions

- **Team:** A collection of people who work together for collective performance.
 - **Group:** A collection of people primarily formed to share information.
- Synergy:** The interaction of elements so that they produce a combined effect greater than the sum of their separate effects.
- **Note:** Teams are expected to produce **positive** synergy, while group synergy is often **neutral or negative**.

Why Have Teams Become So Popular? (from [shot_00-07-11.png]):

- Offer a better way to use employee talents
- Are more flexible and responsive to changing events
- Can quickly assemble, deploy, refocus, and disband
- Facilitate participation in operating decisions
- **Note:** Can be swayed by fads, herd mentality, leading astray.

Comparing Work Groups and Work Teams (from [shot_00-10-04.png]):

- **Goal:** Work Groups aim to "Share information," while Work Teams aim for "Collective performance."
- **Synergy:** Work Groups have "Neutral (sometimes negative)" synergy, while Work Teams have "Positive" synergy.
- **Accountability:** Work Groups have "Individual" accountability; Work Teams have "Mutual" accountability (in addition to individual).

Worked Examples

None yet.

Formulas & Rules

None yet.

Tricky Logic & Traps

- **Team Necessity:** Teams are not a universal requirement; organizations are not obligated to use them. The decision to use a team depends entirely on whether the specific organizational goals require a collective, synergetic approach.
- **Synergy as a Differentiator:** A "Group" may just result in individuals working in parallel (neutral synergy), whereas a "Team" is specifically designed so that individual strengths offset others' weaknesses (positive synergy).
- **Accountability Distinction:** A common point of confusion is the scope of accountability. In a group, accountability is only **individual**. In a team, accountability is both **individual and mutual** (the group

is collectively responsible for the outcome).

- **Skill Selection:** In a group, skill sets are often **random or varied**. In a team, members are intentionally chosen so that their skills are **complementary**.
- **Risk of "Herd" Mentality:** While teams provide flexibility, they are susceptible to "herd mentality" and "fads," which can lead the team astray.

Exam Pointers

None yet.

Sources

- MBAZG511_Managing People and Organizations - Lectures 10-16 (2).pdf
- MBAZG511_Managing People and Organizations - Lectures 10-16.pdf